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Your 21-Day Drifter Pattern Calendar

LB

Eating happens in the background of your day - folded into other activities without a clear moment of decision.



day

SHIFT 1

Notice where you are when it happens.

1

day

The context is the cue.

2

day

What were you doing when eating started?

3

day

You are already eating. Note that.

4

day

SHIFT 2

Stop before the first bite.

5

day

Ten heartbeats before you continue.

6

day

Are you here or somewhere else?

7

day

The pause is the practice.

8

day

You stopped. That is enough.

9

day

SHIFT 3

Plate it before you eat it.

day

Sit down. Every time.

day

Repetition builds the new default.

day

The screen is the cue. Change the context.

day

Eat this. Then do that.

day

Your body was there the whole time.

day

You chose to be present. Note that.

day

SHIFT 4

The pattern is predictable now.

17

day

You know what context triggers this.

18

day

The new default is forming.

19

day

Presence is a practice. Not a destination.

20

day

You already know how to arrive.

21

HOW TO USE

Laminate or slip into a sheet protector with a dry-erase marker. Write the day of the week in each small square. Erase and reuse any time.

CLEAN COPY



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Drifter Pattern Cue Key

Use this side when a calendar phrase needs a reminder. These cues are reminders of what you already know.

SHIFT 1

Notice where you are when it happens.

The Drifter pattern is context-driven, not hunger-driven. The couch, the screen, the kitchen after work - these locations have been paired with eating often enough that they trigger it automatically. The location is the cue.

The context is the cue.

Drifter eating does not begin with hunger. It begins with context. Walking into a familiar space, settling into a familiar activity, transitioning between tasks - any of these can start the pattern without a conscious decision.

What were you doing when eating started?

The Drifter pattern has no clear starting point. Tracing it backward to the activity that preceded it reveals the trigger. That trigger is the thing to interrupt, not the eating itself.

You are already eating. Note that.

The Drifter pattern often surfaces as noticing mid-eating rather than catching the reach before it happens. Noticing mid-process is still noticing. It is still the beginning of the interruption.

SHIFT 2

Stop before the first bite.

The Drifter pattern depends on the absence of a decision point. Creating one - even a brief pause before the first bite - inserts consciousness into an automatic process.

Ten heartbeats before you continue.

Ten seconds of deliberate pause is enough to shift the eating from automatic to chosen. The food does not have to go away. The decision just has to exist.

Are you here or somewhere else?

Drifter eating happens when attention is elsewhere. Asking the question - where is my attention right now - is the presence intervention.

The pause is the practice.

The Drifter pattern does not require dramatic intervention. A consistent, brief pause before eating - every time, regardless of hunger - is the whole practice.

You stopped. That is enough.

Any interruption of the automatic sequence is progress. It does not have to be a complete stop. A pause, a question, a moment of awareness - each one is the pattern breaking.

SHIFT 3

Plate it before you eat it.

Eating from the container, the bag, the pot on the stove removes the visual evidence of quantity. Plating before eating creates a decision and a limit. The plate is the container the Drifter pattern needs.

Sit down. Every time.

Eating while standing, walking, or doing something else is the Drifter pattern's natural environment. Sitting down is a physical commitment to the eating being intentional.

Repetition builds the new default.

The Drifter pattern is a habit loop. Replacing it requires repetition of the new behavior, not willpower. Plate it. Sit down. Every time. The repetition is the intervention.

The screen is the cue. Change the context.

Screens are the most reliable Drifter trigger. Eating in front of a screen pairs the location, the activity, and the eating into a single automatic sequence. Changing any element of that sequence disrupts it.

Eat this. Then do that.

Separating eating from other activities - eating first, then the activity, or activity first, then eating - removes the pairing that drives automatic eating.

Your body was there the whole time.

Drifter eating often feels like discovering you have been eating rather than choosing to eat. Your body registered every bite. Reconnecting to that awareness is the practice.

You chose to be present. Note that.

A meal eaten with full attention - seated, plated, without a screen - is a meal where the Drifter pattern did not run. Note it. It is the evidence that presence is possible.

SHIFT 4

The pattern is predictable now.

You know which contexts trigger automatic eating. That knowledge is the map. The pattern cannot surprise someone who is watching for it.

You know what context triggers this.

The couch, the screen, the transition time, the kitchen after work - you know which one it is for you. Knowing the trigger in advance allows preparation rather than reaction.

The new default is forming.

Plate it. Sit down. Decide. Repeated enough times, this sequence becomes the new automatic. The Drifter pattern does not disappear - it gets replaced by a practiced alternative.

Presence is a practice. Not a destination.

Full awareness at every meal is not the goal. The goal is a practiced response to automatic eating when you notice it happening. Presence is the tool, not the standard.

You already know how to arrive.

You have practiced the pause, the plate, the seat. The response is available. When the context triggers the pattern, the practiced response is there.